

Arrays in PHP

3. Arrays in PHP

In PHP, arrays are ordered data maps and are used to store, manage and operate a set of variables. To put it simply, an array is a data structure that holds multiple data within a single identifier. There are two parts in an Array - Values and Keys. While Values contain information to be stored, Keys are used to identify these values. It is allocated to a single variable. It holds significant information, popularly termed as Array Elements. This information can be used for a number of times in a program. Either non-negative Integers or Strings are used as Keys. The arrays that use non-negative Integers as Keys are termed as Scalar Arrays. These are Associative Arrays that use Strings as keys. An Array may contain different Array(s) popularly known as Multidimensional Arrays. The syntax of an Array is as follows:

```
$array[key] = value;  
Look at the simple example below:  
Example:  
$student_array[0] = "Rohit";  
$student_array[1] = "Rahul";  
$student_array[2] = "Sourav";  
$student_array[3] = "Abdul";
```

In the above example, the names of the students (Rohit, Rahul, Sourav and Abdul) are the Values and the numeric characters (0, 1, 2 and 3) are the Keys of this array.

Scalar array:

The numeric values are used as 'Keys' in Scalar Array. To put it simply, we can use integers as index numbers in scalar arrays. In case of scalar arrays, keys start from zero (0). Look at the examples below:

Example 1:

```
<?php  
$colors = array("red", "brown", "yellow");  
print_r($colors);
```